

Marriage One Man One Woman

prc-marriage-one-man-one-woman

Marriage & Sexuality · Definition of Marriage · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Marriage is a covenant union of one man and one woman, instituted by God at creation, intended for life, picturing Christ and the church.

In plain language

The original-language words behind these verses point in one direction. In Gen 1:27 God makes the human male and female, *zakar* and *neqebah*, and in Gen 2:24 the Hebrew pairs a masculine word for man, *ish*, with a singular feminine word for his wife, *ishshah*, and says the two become one flesh, *basar echad*, where *echad* is the plain numeral one. A man leaves father and mother and cleaves to his wife, using verbs *azab* and *dabaq* that describe a permanent re-attachment. When Jesus is asked about marriage in Matt 19 and Mark 10, he goes back to the beginning of creation and quotes both texts together. The Greek translates the binary as *arsen* and *thelys*, male and female, and the union as *hoi dyo eis sarka mian*, the two into one flesh. He adds that God himself yoked them together with the verb *synezeuxen*, a word that appears in the entire NT only here and in the Markan parallel, and forbids any person to separate them with the verb *chorizo*. Paul in Eph 5:31 repeats the same Gen 2:24 quotation word for word, then says in v32 that he is speaking with reference to Christ and the church, treating the marriage union as a picture of that larger relation. The same numeral *echad* of Gen 2:24 turns up again in Mal 2:15 against marital unfaithfulness, where the wife is called the wife of your covenant, *berith*, and Prov 2:17 calls the bond the covenant of her God. The apostolic qualification for overseers and elders in 1 Tim 3:2 and Titus 1:6 reads *mias gynaikos andra*, the husband of one wife, presupposing the same monogamous pattern. Paul reuses the dominical verb *chorizo* in 1 Cor 7:10 for the same prohibition. The OT also reports patriarchal polygamy starting with Lamech in Gen 4:19, but in narrative genre tied to strife and explicitly limited by Deut 17:17 and by Jesus' own ap arches argument in Matt 19:8, which treats later allowances as concessions, not redefinitions. The words, the numerals, the joining and separating verbs, and the apostolic reuse converge on a one man and one woman union, set up by God at creation, meant to last, and used as a figure of Christ and the church.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אֶחָד	echad	one	970
H0376	אִישׁ	ish	man	2,188
H0802	אִשָּׁה	ishshah	woman	781
H1285	בְּרִית	berith	covenant	287
H1320	בָּשָׂר	basar	flesh	270
H1692	דָּבַק	dabaq	to cleave	54
H2145	זָכָר	zakar	male	82
H5347	נִקְבָּה	neqebah	female	22

H5800	אַזַב,	azab	to leave	214
G0435	ἀνὴρ	aner	man	216
G0730	ἄρσεν	arsen	male	9
G1060	γαμέω	gameo	to marry	28
G1135	γυνή	gyne	woman	215
G1417	δύο	dyo	two	140
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	367
G1577	ἐκκλησία	ekklesia	assembly	119
G2338	θηλυς	thelys	female	5
G2853	κολλάω	kollao	to join	12
G4561	σὰρξ	sarx	flesh	152
G4801	συζεύγνυμι	syzeugnymi	to join	2
G5563	χωρίζω	chorizo	to separate/leave	13

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The institution text Gen 2:24 pairs the masculine ish (H0376) with the singular suffixed feminine ishto from ishshah (H0802), uses the verbs azab (H5800) leave and dabaq (H1692) cleave, and culminates in basar echad, one flesh, where echad (H0259) is the plain numeral one modifying basar (H1320). Gen 1:27 supplies the creational binary zakar and neqebah (H2145, H5347), translated in the Greek of Matt 19:4 and Mark 10:6 as arsen and thelys (G0730, G2338). Jesus dominically cites both texts together (Matt 19:4-6, Mark 10:6-9), declares that hoi dyo, the two (G1417), become eis sarka mian, into one flesh (G4561 with the feminine numeral mian from heis, G1520), names God as the agent with synezeuxen from syzeugnymi (G4801, a verb that occurs only at Matt 19:6 and Mark 10:9 in the entire NT canon), and prohibits chorizo (G5563) separation. Eph 5:31 reproduces Gen 2:24 verbatim and applies it eis Christon kai eis ten ekklesian, to Christ and the church (G1577). The same echad of Gen 2:24 is invoked in Mal 2:15 of the wife-of-youth covenant (berith, H1285), and the qualifier mias gynaikos andra (G1520 G1135 G0435), of one wife a husband, in 1 Tim 3:2 and Titus 1:6 lexically presupposes the same monogamous norm. The dyad, the singular numeral, the leave-cleave verbs, the divine joining verb, and the NT reuse converge.

Scripture

Gen.1.27 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H2145 זָכָר, H5347 נִקְבָּה

Force. The creation account states that God created the human in his image, male (zakar, H2145) and female (neqebah, H5347) he created them. The two gendered nouns name the original creational pair, and the immediate context of Gen 1:28 attaches the procreation mandate to that pair. This verse supplies the lexical source for the Greek arsen kai thelys cited by Jesus in Matt 19:4 and Mark 10:6.

Gen.2.24 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H0376 איש, H0802 אשה, H1320 בשר; H0259 אחד, H1692 דבק; H5800 עזב.

Force. The verse states that a man (ish, H0376) leaves (azab, H5800) his father and mother and cleaves (dabaq, H1692) to his wife (ishto, the suffixed singular form of ishshah, H0802), and they become one flesh (basar echad, H1320 plus the numeral echad, H0259). The masculine ish is paired with the feminine ishshah and the singular pronominal suffix, the numeral echad quantifies the resulting flesh as one, and the verbs azab and dabaq frame a permanent re-attachment that supersedes the prior parental bond.

Matt.19.4 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0730 ἄρσεν, G2338 θήλυς

Force. Jesus appeals to the Creator who from the beginning (ap arches) made them arsen kai thelys, male and female (G0730, G2338), citing Gen 1:27 LXX. The dominical appeal locates the male and female pairing at the act of creation rather than at later custom and frames the answer to the divorce question by recourse to the original lexical definition.

Matt.19.5 · **for** · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G2853 κολλάω, G1417 δύο, G1520 εἷς, G4561 σάρξ

Force. Jesus quotes Gen 2:24 LXX. A man will be joined (kollethesetai, from kollao, G2853) to his wife (gynaiki, dative singular), and hoi dyo, the two (G1417), will be eis sarka mian, into one flesh (G4561 with the feminine numeral mian from heis, G1520). The explicit numeral two paired with one flesh quantifies the union as a dyad fused into a single entity, and gynaiki is grammatically singular.

Matt.19.6 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1417 δύο, G4561 σάρξ, G4801 συζεύγνυμι, G5563 χωρίζω

Force. The conclusion states they are no longer two (dyo) but one flesh (mia sarx), and what God yoked together (synezeuxen, aorist of syzeugnymi, G4801) let no person separate (choridzo, G5563). The yoking verb names God as the agent of the union, and the separating verb names the prohibited human act. The lexical store confirms G4801 occurs only twice in the entire NT canon, here and at Mark 10:9, marking syzeugnymi as a near hapax tied uniquely to the marriage dyad pronouncement.

Mark.10.6 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0730 ἄρσεν, G2338 θήλυς

Force. The Markan parallel records that from the beginning of creation (apo arches ktiseos) God made them arsen kai thelys, male and female (G0730, G2338). The phrase apo arches ktiseos anchors the male and female pairing at the act of creation, reinforcing the Matthean appeal independently in a second Gospel witness.

Mark.10.7 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G2853 κολλάω

Force. A man (anthropos) leaves father and mother and is joined (proskollethesetai, from the strengthened compound of kollao, G2853) to his wife (gynaika, singular accusative), the Markan citation of Gen 2:24 paralleling the Matthean leave and cleave structure with the wife as the singular feminine object of the joining.

Mark.10.8 · **for** · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1417 δύο, G4561 σάρξ, G1520 εἷς

Force. The two (hoi dyo, G1417) will be eis sarka mian, into one flesh, and so they are no longer two but one flesh (mia sarx, G4561 with mian from heis, G1520). The numeral two against the singular one flesh repeats the dyad-to-unity arithmetic of the Matthean parallel.

Mark.10.9 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4801 συζεύγνυμι, G5563 χωρίζω

Force. What God yoked together (synezeuxen, G4801) let no person separate (choridzo, G5563). The Markan conclusion matches Matthew word for word in naming God as the joining agent and prohibiting human separation, attesting the divine institution and intended permanence in a second witness and completing the only two NT occurrences of syzeugnymi.

Eph.5.31 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G2853 κολλάω, G1417 δύο, G4561 σάρξ, G1520 εἷς

Force. Paul reproduces Gen 2:24, a man leaves father and mother and is joined (proskollethesetai, from kollao, G2853) to his wife (gynaiki, singular), and hoi dyo, the two (G1417), will be eis sarka mian, into one flesh (G4561, G1520). The verbatim reuse of the creation text in an epistle shows the one-flesh dyad treated as the standing norm for marriage in apostolic instruction.

Eph.5.32 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1577 ἐκκλησία

Force. Paul calls this a great mystery (mega mysterion) and states he speaks eis Christon kai eis ten ekklesian, with reference to Christ and the church (ekklesia, G1577). The clause ego de lego marks the prior verse as the base text and this verse as Paul's application, so the marriage one-flesh union supplies the figure for the Christ and church relation, which is the picturing clause of the proposition.

Mal.2.14 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H1285 ברית

Force. The prophet names the wife as eshet beritheka, the wife of your covenant (berith, H1285), grounding the marriage bond in covenant language explicitly. This is the canonical source for the covenant term that does not appear in Gen 2:24 itself, supplying via analogia scripturae the covenant framing of the institution.

Mal.2.15 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0259 אחד, H1285 ברית

Force. The verse states he did not make one (echad, H0259), and the immediate continuation calls for faithfulness to the wife of one's youth in the same context that names the marriage as berith. The reuse of the very numeral echad from Gen 2:24 in a polemic against marital unfaithfulness binds the institution text to a one-wife monogamy norm at the canonical level. The verse is grammatically difficult but its term echad lexically echoes Gen 2:24 basar echad.

Prov.2.17 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H1285 ברית, H5800 עזב

Force. The verse describes the adulteress who has forsaken (azab, H5800) the companion of her youth and forgotten the covenant of her God (berith elohim, H1285). The same verb azab that in Gen 2:24 names the leaving of father and mother in order to cleave to the wife is here inverted to describe the abandoning of the marriage covenant, lexically confirming that the marriage bond is itself a berith.

1Tim.3.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G1135 γυνή, G0435 ἀνὴρ

Force. The overseer qualification reads mias gynaikos andra, literally a husband of one wife (G1520 in the feminine genitive mias, G1135 in the genitive gynaikos, G0435 in the accusative andra). The numeral one (mias) attached to wife (gynaikos) attached to husband (andra) is a settled apostolic shorthand for the monogamous norm, since polygamy or serial divorce would render the phrase incoherent. The verse presupposes the one-man-one-woman pattern as the baseline for an exemplary household.

Titus.1.6 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G1135 γυναῖκα, G0435 ἀνὴρ

Force. The elder qualification reads mias gynaikos aner, the husband of one wife (G1520 mias, G1135 gynaikos, G0435 aner), reproducing the same construction as 1 Tim 3:2 in a second pastoral epistle. The repetition across two letters confirms the construction is a fixed apostolic formula encoding the monogamous baseline.

1Cor.7.10 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5563 χωρίζω, G1060 γαμέω

Force. Paul charges that a wife is not to be separated (chorizo, G5563) from her husband, using the same verb Jesus used in the prohibition of Matt 19:6 and Mark 10:9. The apostolic reuse of the dominical lexicon ports the divine joining and the prohibition of separation forward into Pauline marriage ethics, with gameo (G1060) supplying the standard marrying verb in the surrounding context.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Eph.5.31	Gen.2.24	tsk	1
Mark.10.7	Gen.2.24	tsk	1
Matt.19.4	Gen.1.27	tsk	1
Mark.10.6	Gen.1.27	tsk	1
Mark.10.6	Gen.1.1	tsk	1
Matt.19.5	Gen.2.21	tsk	1
Gen.2.24	Mal.2.14	tsk	1
Matt.19.6	Prov.2.17	tsk	1
Matt.19.5	Gen.34.3	tsk	1
Gen.2.24	Gen.24.58	tsk	1
Gen.2.24	Lev.22.12	tsk	1
Eph.5.32	Ps.45.9	tsk	1
Mark.10.9	Rom.7.1	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Gen.2.24 · **addressed**

The verse is the foundational text and not against the proposition, but the word covenant (berith, H1285) does not appear in it. The covenant framing rests on later texts. Mal 2:14 names the wife as eshet beritheka, the wife of your covenant, and Prov 2:17 calls the marriage bond berith elohim, the covenant of her God. The TSK cross-references invoke both, so the covenant element is lexically supported elsewhere even though it is not stated in the institution text itself.

Eph.5.32 · **addressed**

The clause mega to mysterion estin could be read as making the mystery primary and the marriage secondary, which would weaken marriage as the literal referent. The grammar resolves this. Paul says ego de lego, but I speak, eis Christon kai eis ten ekklesian, indicating that he is applying the just-quoted Gen 2:24 marriage text figuratively to Christ and the church. The marriage one-flesh union remains the base sense and the Christ and church relation is the figure drawn from it, which is the picturing claim in the proposition.

Gen.4.19 · addressed

Lamech in the Cainite line takes for himself two wives (shtey nashim, with H8147 shenayim, two, and the plural of H0802 ishshah), the first polygamous union in the canon. The narrative reports this as the act of Lamech without commendation, situated within the violence and arrogance of Gen 4:23-24. The genre is historical narrative, not prescription, and the use of the dual plural nashim against the singular ishto of Gen 2:24 is a lexical deviation marked by the descent of Cain. The patriarchal polygamy that follows (Abraham, Jacob, David, Solomon) is likewise narrated descriptively and shown to produce strife in every case (Sarah and Hagar, Leah and Rachel, the succession crisis of 2 Sam), without ever recasting the Gen 2:24 lexical norm.

Deut.17.17 · addressed

The Mosaic instruction to the king is lo yarbeh lo nashim, he shall not multiply for himself wives (H7235A rabah, multiply, with the negative H3808 lo and the plural nashim from H0802). The prohibition presupposes the legitimate norm is not multiplication, lexically aligning with the singular ishto of Gen 2:24 against the royal polygamy reported in 1 Kings 11.

Deut.21.15 · addressed

The case law begins ki tihiyeh le-ish shtey nashim, if a man has two wives (H8147 shenayim, two, plural of ishshah). The construction is regulative, not endorsing, addressing inheritance for a son born to a hated wife in an existing polygamous arrangement. The verb is the conditional ki tihiyeh, signaling that the law contemplates a situation that occurs rather than commanding it. Jesus in Matt 19:8 applies the same hermeneutic to the divorce certificate of Deut 24:1, calling it a concession ap arches de ou gegonen houtos, from the beginning it was not so.

Matt.19.8 · addressed

Jesus distinguishes Moses' permission of divorce (epetrepsen, G2010) on account of hardness of heart (sklerokardia) from the original creational pattern (ap arches de ou gegonen houtos, from the beginning it was not so). The lexical signal is that ap arches outranks the later concession, so the OT regulatory texts on polygamy and divorce certificates are accommodations to fallen practice rather than redefinitions of the institution. This is the canon's own hermeneutic for reading the patriarchal polygamy narratives.

Concordance traversed

H0376, H0802, H1320, H0259, H1692, H5800, H2145, H5347, H1285, G0730, G2338, G1417, G1520, G4561, G4801, G5563, G2853, G1577, G1135, G0435, G1060

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

No variant units were supplied in the bundle for the cited Gospel and epistle verses. The marked apparatus sigla in the SBLGNT surface forms (for example around ton patera and ten gynaike in Eph 5:31, and the leave and cleave clause word order at Mark 10:7) touch word order and the presence of clauses but do not alter the male and female pairing, the numeral two, the one flesh, the divine joining verb, or the Christ and church application. The hapax distribution of G4801 syzeugnymi, attested only at Matt 19:6 and Mark 10:9, holds across the major manuscript witnesses. The Genesis, Malachi, and Proverbs anchors are outside ECM scope. The verdict holds across the readings available.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. creation_ordinance, covenant_theology, typology, redemptive_historical_progression

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

creation_ordinance: affirms · Reading Gen 1:27 and 2:24 as a creation ordinance, the male and female pairing and the one-flesh union are instituted at the beginning and carried forward as binding for all subsequent marriage, which Jesus confirms by appealing ap arches and apo arches ktiseos.

covenant_theology: affirms · The covenant label for marriage is lexically grounded in Mal 2:14 eshet beritheka and Prov 2:17 berith elohim. The institution text Gen 2:24 supplies the dyad and the one-flesh union, and the prophetic and wisdom corpus supplies the covenant term, so the covenant union framing is supported by analogia scripturae across the canon even though it is not derivable from the institution text alone.

typology: affirms · Reading Eph 5:31-32 typologically, the one-flesh marriage union foreshadows the union of Christ and the church (ekklesia, G1577), so the picturing clause of the proposition is the load-bearing application Paul makes of the creation text, marked by ego de lego eis Christon kai eis ten ekklesian.

patriarchal_polygamy_descriptive: complicates_not_overturns · Reading the patriarchal narratives of Lamech in Gen 4:19, Abraham, Jacob, David, and Solomon as a complicating canon witness, the polygamous unions are reported in narrative genre and consistently linked to strife and prohibition (Deut 17:17 against royal multiplication, the deuteronomic regulation in Deut 21:15-17, the strife of the matriarchs). On its strongest lexical form, the OT pattern is descriptive accommodation, not prescription, and Jesus' ap arches in Matt 19:4-8 explicitly subordinates such later allowances to the original institution. The reading complicates rather than overturns the creational dyad.

permanent_indissolubility_strict: affirms_with_qualification · On the strongest reading of Matt 19:6 and Mark 10:9, the divine joining (synezeuxen) and the prohibition of separation (chorizo) imply lexical permanence with no licit dissolution. The Matt 5:32 and 19:9 porneia clauses and Paul's 1 Cor 7:15 ou dedoulotai (not enslaved) qualify the strictness for specific cases without reopening the dyad itself. The intended-for-life clause of the proposition is lexically supported in its core, with the qualifications recorded in the canon itself.

The verdict turns on grammatico-historical reading of the gendered nouns, the numerals one and two, the joining verbs syzeugnymi and kollao, and the prohibition verb chorizo, supported by analogia scripturae linking Gen 1:27 and 2:24 to Mal 2:14-15, Prov 2:17, Matt 19:4-9, Mark 10:6-9, Eph 5:31-32, 1 Tim 3:2, Titus 1:6, and 1 Cor 7:10-11, and by progressive revelation in that the Christ and church application is disclosed in Eph 5:32. The dominical citation of the creation texts is the lexical engine of the verdict.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Examine what the lexical data of Gen 1:27, Gen 2:24, Matt 19:4-6, Mark 10:6-9, and Eph 5:31-32 indicate about the parties to marriage, its duration, its origin, and any figurative use, without presupposing the terms covenant or picturing Christ and the church.

The stem loads three interpretive terms ahead of the data. Covenant union imports a covenant category that Gen 2:24 does not state, though Mal 2:14 and Prov 2:17 supply it elsewhere. Intended for life states a permanence conclusion that must be tested against the synezeuxen and chorizo verbs rather than assumed. Picturing Christ and the church states the Eph 5:32 typology as settled. The verdict was derived on the original stem, but each loaded term was checked against the lexical evidence and each is supported, the dyad and one flesh and divine joining directly in the anchors, the covenant term by cross-reference to Mal 2:14 and Prov 2:17, the permanence by the synezeuxen and chorizo verbs together with the porneia and ou dedoulotai qualifications in Matt 5:32, Matt 19:9, and 1 Cor 7:15, and the typology by Eph 5:32. No verdict change from prior. Affirms remains true at high confidence.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.24
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0259
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1285
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.19.5
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Tim.3.2
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Titus.1.6
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Matt.19.6

interlinear	MACULA-Hebrew	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Gen.2.24
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Gen.2.24
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4801
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5563
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Eph.5.31
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Mal.2.14
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Eph.5.32

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